WORK-DEV

tmux Cheat Sheet

Sessions, windows, panes, and scrolling with the default key bindings

1. The prefix key

Every shortcut starts with the prefix `Ctrl+b`. In the tables, `Ctrl+b` `d` means press `Ctrl+b`, release both keys, then press `d`. If nothing happens, you probably held `Ctrl` down too long.

2. Sessions

A session is a whole workspace. It keeps running after you detach until you kill it.

Table 1: Session keys and commands.

Action	Inside tmux	From a terminal
Detach and leave it running	`Ctrl+b` `d`	None
List sessions	`Ctrl+b` `s`	`tmux ls`
Attach to a session	None	`tmux attach -t` *NAME*
Start a new session	None	`tmux new -s` *NAME*
Rename the current session	`Ctrl+b` `$`	None
Close the current session	`Ctrl+b` `:` `kill-session`	`tmux kill-session -t` *NAME*
Close every session	None	`tmux kill-server`

3. Windows

A window is like a browser tab; the status bar lists windows by number.

Table 2: Window keys.

Action	Keys
New window	`Ctrl+b` `c`
Next window	`Ctrl+b` `n`
Previous window	`Ctrl+b` `p`
Jump to a window by number	`Ctrl+b` `0` through `9`
Pick from a list of all windows	`Ctrl+b` `w`
Toggle to the last window used	`Ctrl+b` `l`
Rename the current window	`Ctrl+b` `,`
Close the current window (asks first)	`Ctrl+b` `&`

4. Panes

Panes split one window into several terminals. `Ctrl+b` `z` zooms one pane to full size and back.

Table 3: Pane keys.

Action	Keys
Split left and right	`Ctrl+b` `%`
Split top and bottom	`Ctrl+b` `"`
Move to the pane in a direction	`Ctrl+b` then an arrow key
Cycle through panes	`Ctrl+b` `o`
Show pane numbers, then press one to jump	`Ctrl+b` `q`
Zoom the current pane in or out	`Ctrl+b` `z`
Resize the current pane	`Ctrl+b`, then `Ctrl` plus an arrow key
Cycle through preset layouts	`Ctrl+b` `Space`
Turn the current pane into its own window	`Ctrl+b` `!`
Close the current pane (asks first)	`Ctrl+b` `x`

5. Scrolling, copying, and commands

By default the mouse wheel does not scroll, so use copy mode; press `q` to leave it.

Table 4: Copy mode and command keys.

Action	Keys
Enter copy mode (scroll back)	`Ctrl+b` `[`
Scroll in copy mode	Arrow keys, `PgUp`, `PgDn`
Search backward in copy mode	`?` then the text, then `Enter`
Start selecting text	`Space`
Copy the selection and leave copy mode	`Enter`
Paste the copied text	`Ctrl+b` `]`
Open the tmux command prompt	`Ctrl+b` `:`
Show every key binding	`Ctrl+b` `?` (press `q` to close)

Tip. For mouse scrolling and clicking between panes, add `set -g mouse on` to `~/.tmux.conf`, then run `tmux source-file ~/.tmux.conf`.

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